

Low Testosterone Bob

CHAPTER 20

Supplemental Dialogue for the Beginner Workbook

by Peter Mangiaracina

BOB

Good morning, Dr. Darfmueller.

DR. DARFMUELLER

Good morning. Please have a seat.

BOB

Thank you

(Bob sits)

DR. DARFMUELLER

Just let me check your details.

(The doctor looks at his computer)

DR. DARFMUELLER

Is this your first visit to this clinic?

BOB

No. I've been here before. Your son, Manfred, has seen me twice.

DR. DARFMUELLER

Okay. Your name is Bob Booberson?

BOB

Yes.

DR. DARFMUELLER

And you are 69 years old?

BOB

That's right.

DR. DARFMUELLER

Okay. Great. Now. How can I help you?

BOB

Lately, I've been feeling fatigued, and I've noticed a significant decrease in my libido.

DR. DARFMUELLER

Ah. Yes. Fatigue and a reduced sex drive can be indicative of low testosterone levels. Any other symptoms?

BOB

Apart from fatigue and a decreased sex drive, I haven't noticed any other significant changes. However, I have been trying to build muscle mass at the gym. But, even though I go every day, and I have a personal trainer, I can't seem to make any progress.

DR. DARFMUELLER

That, too, is consistent with low testosterone levels. It's also important to consider various factors that can influence testosterone production. Lifestyle choices, such as diet, exercise habits, and stress levels, can significantly impact hormone levels.

BOB

I understand. I try to maintain a balanced diet, but I like to eat.

DR. DARFMUELLER

How much do you weigh?

BOB

About 110 kilos.

DR. DARFMUELLER

Testosterone can get trapped in the adipose tissue. Losing weight might free your testosterone.

BOB

Also, I work 12 hours a day, and as I get older, I'm starting to feel the stress. Can that affect my hormone levels, too?

DR. DARFMUELLER

Absolutely. A healthy lifestyle, encompassing regular exercise, a well-balanced diet, and effective stress management, plays a crucial role in maintaining optimal hormone levels. In some instances, addressing these lifestyle factors can naturally enhance testosterone production. Nonetheless, it is essential to thoroughly assess your specific situation and rule out any underlying medical conditions.

BOB

Okay. What would be the next steps then? Are there any tests or treatments I should consider?

DR. DARFMUELLER

We will need to do a blood test. We may also need to evaluate other potential factors, such as thyroid function or underlying medical conditions that could impact hormone production. When we get back the results, we can discuss appropriate treatment options. In some cases, increasing exercise and improving sleep patterns may be sufficient. However, if necessary, testosterone replacement therapy can also be considered. It is important to note that the choice of treatment will depend on your specific needs and the underlying cause of your low testosterone levels.

BOB

Thanks for taking the time to explain everything.

DR. DARFMUELLER

You're welcome. Let's begin by scheduling the blood test, and based on the results, we can develop a personalized plan of action. Speak to the receptionist and she'll schedule the test for you and our follow-up appointment.

BOB

Thank you.